

The animal's tail acted as a counterbalance.

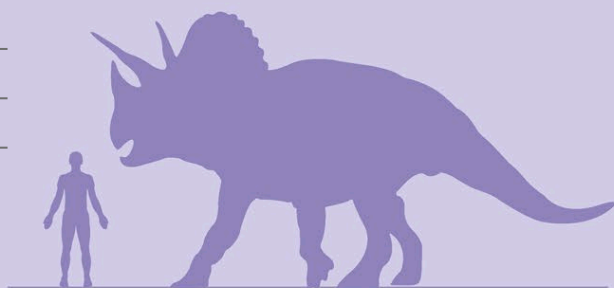
FANTASTIC FRILLS

TRICERATOPS

With its eye-catching brow horns and dramatic frill, the enormous head of an adult *Triceratops* was probably an intimidating sight, even for a big, hungry theropod. In the past, this creature was often portrayed as a lone herbivore, but new finds are challenging this idea of a solitary lifestyle and suggest that *Triceratops* may have lived in groups, like many similar species. The creature had a parrotlike beak and numerous teeth, which it used to snip off and grind down low-lying vegetation.

AT A GLANCE

- **LENGTH** 26–30 ft (8–9 m)
- **DIET** Herbivore
- **LIVED** 68–66 MYA
- **HABITAT** Dry forests and open plains



STATS AND FACTS

Triceratops was one of the last nonbird dinosaurs to evolve in the Cretaceous Period. Its skulls are common in the Late Cretaceous rocks of North America, most likely due to their bulky size, which helped them withstand the test of time.

HORN SIZE



Triceratops had two brow horns, which grew to 4 ft (1.3 m) and had strong, bony cores.

WEIGHT



Paleontologists estimate that the weight of this herbivore could have ranged from 5.5 to 15.4 tons (5 to 14 tonnes).